

Nov 2013 : “Fame and Celebrity”
Answer Scheme

- 1) In the first paragraph, which qualities apart from courage does the author see demonstrated by ancient heroes? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
charisma (line 4) resilience (line 2)	They also demonstrated the ability to charm others/ They have an attractive/appealing personality (1) and tenacity/determination/strength in the face of setbacks. (1)

Commented [THZ1]: {Not ‘people like them’ (0)}

- 2) Explain the author’s use of the word ‘seemingly in line 3. [1]

From the Text	Inference
...battling against seemingly insurmountable obstacles...	‘Seemingly’ suggests that the obstacles the heroes battled against looked/appeared to be insurmountable to ordinary people, but in actual fact were quite manageable to these heroes. (1) <i>It is wrong to explain that these battles are over-rated/ exaggerated and turned out to be easier than first thought. This would diminish the heroes’ achievement in overcoming them or lower the heroes’ stature, which is not the point the author is suggesting!</i>

- 3) Why has the author placed brackets around the comment in lines 22-23? [2]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
	The use of the brackets is to show that the content of the material contained within the brackets does not fit the point about the positive impact heroes’ achievements have on the community. (1)

Commented [THZ2]: Generic function of brackets

	The bracketed observation points out that the reverse situation is also true – the community can be adversely affected by the failure of a hero. (1) <i>It is incorrect to explain that the bracketed material <u>contradicted</u> the earlier point made.</i>
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4) What is the author implying by writing 'celebrities' in inverted commas in line 36? [1]

From the Text	Inference
...no talent other than that one for self-promotion: 'celebrities', who do nothing worthy of celebration.	He is implying the label 'celebrity' is an undeserved epithet for such people who are unworthy of fame. <i>'The author is being ironic/sarcastic' is not an acceptable answer without answering in context and giving explanation.</i>

5) What contrast about images of the famous before and after the printing of photographs is the author presenting in lines 39-41? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Suggested explanation and paraphrase
The actual faces of the powerful and famous, which were once in idealised form on coins, statues or engravings...	Before the printing of photographs, the images of the famous were romanticised/they were depicted in a favourable way people ought to view them. (1) In contrast, the printed photographs enabled people to see their true likeness/real appearance. (1) <i>Focus should not be on the media through which the images were transmitted, something rare/permanent versus something more widely available/ephemeral.</i>

6) In paragraphs 7-8, what explanations does the author offer for the development of a personal attachment to celebrities? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [3]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
Fascination with celebrities may offer an antidote to the perception of day-to-day existence as routine and colourless (lines 47-48)	Our interest in celebrities may serve as a means to alleviate/counter the sense of predictability and boredom in our every life/ our humdrum existence is made more interesting when we develop an interest in celebrities. [1]
...being an adherent of a celebrity may be a way of rekindling the hero-worship they first experienced ... felt for their parents – with whom they are now disenchanted (lines 60-62)	Being fans of celebrities can help people rediscover/re-ignite the adulation they once had for their parents who have now fallen off the pedestal/ whom these people are now disillusioned with. [1]
..in a world where religion is losing some of its centrality to people's lives, celebrities fill the vacuum , on some level satisfying an innate desire to idolise . (lines 62-64)	Celebrities fill a void left behind by the diminished role/importance of religion in their lives, fulfilling an inborn/natural desire to worship another. [1] <i>References to fans' jealousy, the fickleness of their attachments and the rapid succession of new celebrities replacing those who have fallen out of favour are all irrelevant. The inclusion of these shows the students' lack of selectivity of points related to the reasons for an interest in celebrities.</i>

7) Why does the author describe the findings of the research mentioned in line 64 as 'unsurprising'? [1]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
...research suggests that members of a formal religion are far less likely to profess interest in celebrities than those who are not. (lines 65-66)	The survey findings do not surprise the author because religious people are already worshipping their own god and

	thus they have no void in their lives that have to be filled by celebrity worship.[1] <i>The question does not ask what 'surprising' means. Nor does the question focus on those who do idolise celebrities.</i>
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- 8) How do the more contemporary heroes mentioned in lines 77-78 differ from the ancient heroes referred to in paragraph 1. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase/Explanation
...warlike qualities (line 3) ...Gandhi's unflinching adherence to non-violence (line 78-79) Qualities traditionally associated with the masculine is what denied women such fame...(line 5-6) Mother Theresa's compassion... (line 77-78)	The ancient heroes earned their reputation from their aggressive deeds; the contemporary heroes cited were peace advocates of social change. (1) Also, ancient heroes were exclusively males while contemporary heroes include women. (1)

- 9) Identify three characteristics of traditional heroism mentioned in paragraph 9 which the story of Jonas Salk in paragraph10 demonstrates. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [3]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
...fame in its traditional sense ...was gradually earned by what may be a lifetime's patient development of skills, achievements or attributes (lines 72-73) ...years of dedicated research (line 80-81)	The story of Jonas Salk demonstrates that he was like the traditional hero in that his fame was achieved through his hard work/ research efforts over a long period of time (1). His devotion to serving others without regard for benefits like wealth and glory

... selfless dedication (line 85)	saw him rejecting lucrative deals and public displays of veneration for him (1)
...the betterment of the lives of others (line 76)/ welfare of mankind (line 85)	His vaccine has saved millions of people over the years from contracting polio, thus contributing significantly in improving the health of the human race. (1)

10. Using material from paragraphs 2-4 only, summarise what the author has to say about what defines a hero, why heroes are significant to a society and to individuals, and how their failings do not undermine their importance. Write your summary in no more than 120 words, not counting the opening words which are printed below. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [8]

Heroes may distinguish themselves in many ways. Firstly, they...

	From the passage	Possible paraphrase
a	...associated with the extraordinary (line 9)	are linked to those who are exceptional/outstanding
b	the inspirational (line 9)	and highly admirable/awesome
c	whether in the field of sporting endeavour, artistic creation, scientific discovery... righting of wrongs (lines 9-11)	across a spectrum of human achievements and missions.
d	...essential to societies... they embody the attributes a society values (line 12)	They are necessary to societies as they represent the qualities these societies hold dear/cherish
e	and, as such, provide role models for members of that community (line 12-13)	and serve as positive examples for people to emulate.
f	Such people could be at the absolute limits of our aspirations (line 13-14)	They represent the loftiest/highest/the pinnacle of our dreams/goals
g	their qualities we wished we possessed (line 14)	and their traits are those we desire to own/yearn for.
h	These heroes are adventurous risk-takers (lines 14-15)	Heroes are brave/courageous in seeking opportunities/taking chances
i	perhaps we admire them as we do not want to take those risks ourselves (lines 14-15)	which we are too cowardly to do and hence we look up to them
j	Or we know that such achievements, are frankly, beyond us (line 16)	or we know we cannot succeed in/pull off.
k	...the heroes that are personally admired extend people's sense of what is possible for humans to achieve (lines 17-18)	Individuals have the limits to what they think humans can do challenged by heroes
l	As well as reflecting cherished values (line 18)	and their heroes show these individuals' respected virtues
m	and accomplishments (line 19)	and achievements.
n	laudable achievements...may increase the unity (line 21)	These accomplishments can enhance social cohesion
o	self-esteem of that grouping (line 21)	and the morale/self-regard of a community
p	as it takes pride in the feats of one of its own (line 21-22)	as it gets an ego-boost/sense of honour from one of its own member's great success.

q	...failings humanise these people (line 27)	Failings make heroes real/true to life,
r	making them more like us (line 27)	more relatable/more similar to ourselves
s	and thus more within our capacity to emulate (lines 27-28)	and thus makes it easier for us to model after them.
t	Their weaknesses did not stop their accomplishing so much and this is encouraging (lines 28-29)	Their flaws did not greatly obstruct their path to success and this is heartening/reassuring/ this motivates us
u	as perhaps, we with our faults, might achieve in the same way (lines 29-30)	as we feel that we too can succeed despite our failings.

1-2pts: 1m, 3-4pts:2m, 5-6pts:3m, 7-8pts:4m, 9-10pts:5m, 11-12pts: 6m, 13 pts: 7m, 14pts and above: 8m

The Application Question

In this article, Hilary Johns distinguishes between actions which earn 'true fame' and the modern day interest in the actions of celebrities who 'have not talent other than one for self-promotion.' How far would you agree with Hilary John's observations? Relate your opinions to your own society. (10)

Note: Please check in with Mr Tan regarding the AQ